

Follow the breadcrumbs

A *rgumentum e silentio* - A common fallacy wherein people assume what they don't see (or hear, if we're being literal) isn't there at all. And this comes to the fore in cases such as this one – assessing the popularity of operating systems. Naysayers have regularly asked the question, 'if Linux is so good, then why isn't anybody using it?'. Forgive the naysayers, they aren't the brightest of the bunch when it comes to the intricacies of the philosophical sciences.

Truth be told, we've met more people who've tried Linux at some point in time and given up on it, than those who haven't. Don't worry we're benevolent beings and we wouldn't begrudge you if you're one of them. Until as recently as 2010, the Linux ecosystem was not the most inviting of places, especially for a newcomer. Having allegedly been the domain of neckbeard hackers and boy-genius techies, Linux had somehow blocked itself out of the reckoning for the regular folk.

But that is not the case anymore. Distros have made sincere attempts at making sure the new folk feel at home. Give them a spin!

Then there were people who had truly given Linux a chance. They toiled hard, and learnt the mysterious ways of the sudo, hoping that they would eventually thrive one day. That day never came. Nobody would say that Linux evangelists haven't made a bundle of excuses of why, somehow, that thing you want to do on your machine is just not possible, at the moment. A majority of 'those things' are now possible to do. And we mean a vast majority, partly because Linux has improved a lot over the past few years, and partly because the rest has moved to that small thing that is almost entirely powered by Linux – the cloud!

Finally, there are people who've been looking at the whole thing from the outside, filling up with curiosity as to what the fuss is about.